POOJA KINI

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PROFILE

Social researcher working across critical scholarship, applied research, evaluation and policy practice, with 10+ years' experience designing and delivering mixed-methods research and evaluation for institutional funders, charities and government. My work examines how institutions, policies and infrastructure shape urban and environmental conditions and distribute resources and opportunities unequally. I bring experience in research design, multi-site fieldwork, programme evaluation, MEL systems, data analysis and translating evidence into practical recommendations for policy and practice. My academic research is grounded in feminist, decolonial and intersectional approaches to urban and environmental governance.

CORE CAPABILITIES

Research design and delivery: Qualitative, quantitative and mixed-methods research; research methodologies and tools; multi-site studies; sampling and survey design; fieldwork planning; research ethics and quality assurance.

Evaluation and learning: Monitoring, evaluation and learning frameworks; theories of change, logframes and indicators; baseline, midline and endline studies; impact assessments; KAP assessments; adaptive learning.

Methods and analysis: Semi-structured interviews, ethnography, life histories, focus groups, participatory visual mapping, walking interviews/tours, observation, surveys, document and policy analysis; statistical analysis and data management.

Evidence, reporting and influence: Evidence syntheses, donor reports, policy briefs, research outputs and presentations; translating findings for funders, government, practitioners and academic audiences.

Partnerships and facilitation: Multi-stakeholder engagement; facilitation of workshops and learning sessions; training and capacity-building; coordination of research teams and external evaluators; proposal and budget contributions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Data Consultant (part-time) | Woman's Trust, London | *2023 and 2025*

- Supported donor reporting across an organisation managing more than £828k in annual grant and project funding, preparing annual, quarterly and monthly reports for GLA Advance, GLA Refuge, London Councils, LVRU, City Bridge Trust and other institutional funders.
- Managed and analysed programme outcome and impact data, maintaining datasets across Excel, Power BI, online surveys and CRM systems; produced evidence reports and responded to internal and external data requests.
- Contributed to improvements in data-collection processes and organisational learning systems, maintaining tracking tools and training staff in data quality, reporting and data-system use.

MEL Consultant – Just Transition Research (part-time) | Purpose India | *2023–2024*

- Led MacArthur Foundation-funded qualitative and mixed-methods research across multiple states in North India's brick-kiln sector, examining pathways and challenges for a just transition to low-carbon production.
- Designed indicators, reporting mechanisms and logframes across partner organisations, supporting consistent monitoring and learning across the research programme.
- Translated research findings into policy and practitioner outputs, including a peer-reviewed publication on just transitions.

Manager, Research and Knowledge Management | PCI India | *2020–2022*

- Led interdisciplinary, donor-funded research and evaluation across India, including a JICA-funded impact assessment on migrant workers in partnership with KPMG, and qualitative research on gender, reproductive health and social norms; coordinated multi-state teams and fieldwork.
- Designed and implemented MEL systems for UMANG, a gender-transformative programme reaching 178,000+ women and 46,000+ adolescent girls across seven districts and 43 blocks in Jharkhand; developed indicators, learning frameworks, data-collection systems and evidence products.
- Produced evidence syntheses, impact assessments, theories of change, donor reports and policy briefs for government, donor and institutional audiences, translating findings into programme and policy recommendations.
- Developed knowledge-management and evidence-sharing systems for gender and women's empowerment portfolios, supporting learning, dissemination and advocacy.

National Programme Associate | The Hunger Project India | *2018–2020*

- Led and contributed to donor-funded evaluations across a six-state portfolio reaching 5.5 million+ people, including baseline, midline and endline studies assessing women's empowerment, participation and agency among elected women representatives.
- Developed logframes and evidence frameworks for institutional donors including AJWS, BMZ Germany, UNFPA and philanthropic foundations.
- Strengthened monitoring, learning and evidence systems, including development of a digital MIS with an external consultant to track programme outcomes and improvements to the organisation's global database.
- Led adaptive research and evaluation during the COVID-19 emergency response, assessing relief measures and adapting data-collection and training approaches to pandemic restrictions.

Team Lead | CMS India | *2016–2018*

- Led research and evaluation assignments across sustainable agriculture, human development, irrigation, public health, nutrition, sanitation and hygiene.
- Designed quantitative and qualitative surveys and evaluation approaches, including data collection, cleaning and statistical analysis using STATA and SPSS.
- Managed client relationships and contributed to proposals and third-party evaluations for organisations including UNICEF C4D, Aga Khan Rural Support Programme, Tata Trusts and Akshaya Patra Foundation.

ACADEMIC RESEARCH AND TEACHING

Doctoral Researcher | Birkbeck, University of London | *2022–2026*

- PhD thesis submitted September 2026: "Governing Lives by Manufacturing Scarcity: Intersectional and Multiscalar Politics of Water Infrastructure in Jaipur, India" (degree pending).
- Designed and conducted 12 months of multi-sited ethnographic research across three informal settlements in Jaipur, examining water governance, infrastructure access and intersectional inequality.
- Methods included interviews, life histories, focus group discussions, participatory mapping, walking tours, observation and analysis of policy documents, scheme guidelines, parliamentary debates, court orders and institutional reports.
- Examined water infrastructure and scarcity across national, state, city, settlement, household and embodied scales, translating findings into academic, policy and practitioner-facing outputs.

Guest Teacher | London School of Economics | *2025–present*

- Teach and facilitate classes on sustainable development, urban geography and gender, space and power, STS.
- Provide formative and summative feedback, individual guidance and dissertation support through Methodology Surgery.
- Support students with qualitative and mixed-methods research design and academic writing; contribute to teaching and assessment planning with module convenors.

Postgraduate Teaching Assistant | University College London | *2025*

- Teaching support in Geographies of Infrastructure and Environmental Knowledges.

EDUCATION

PhD, Geography, Environment and Development Studies (submitted) | Birkbeck, University of London | 2022–2026

MA, Sustainable Development Practice | TERI School of Advanced Studies, New Delhi | 2014–2016

BSc (Hons), Anthropology | University of Delhi | 2011–2014

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Bhullar, H. & Kini, P. (2025). "A contextual understanding of just transitions in Uttar Pradesh's brick industry." GeoProgress Journal.
- Kini, P. (in press, 2026). "Intersectional gendered experiences of water infrastructure: Case study of Lakshman Basti." In Challenging the Usual: Water Assessments with a Gender Perspective. UNESCO World Water Assessment Programme. Open access.
- Kini, P. "Governing Water infrastructure and supply through Informality in Jaipur." Water Alternatives. Under review.
- Kini, P. "Burdened Bodies under Water Stress: Embodied Emotions and Everyday Life in Urban India". Submitted to: Gender, Place & Culture.

- Kini, P. "Reframing Urban Water Governance: Intersectional and Multiscalar Perspectives from Urban Margins". GeoForum. In preparation.

METHODS AND SOFTWARE

Quantitative: STATA, SPSS, Excel, Power BI; survey design, data cleaning, descriptive and statistical analysis.

Qualitative: ATLAS.ti, NVivo; coding and thematic analysis of interview, focus-group and discourse analysis.

Research and evaluation: Mixed-methods design, Difference in difference, RCT, sampling, interviews, life histories, focus groups, participatory mapping, observation, baseline/midline/endline evaluation, programme evaluation, KPIs, theories of change and MEL frameworks

Data collection and management: ODK, CommCare, SurveyMonkey, CRM and digital MIS platforms, OASIS